

DELHI | Talking Heads

MUIVAH WITH HOME MINISTER P. CHIDAMBARAM

Socialist Council of Nagaland (NSCN-IM), Isak Chishi Swu and Thuingaleng Muivah are back again in Delhi to push their demand for Nagalim, or Greater Nagaland. Begun in 1997, the Centre's talks with the Naga rebels have reached nowhere so far. The last time Muivah was in Delhi three years ago, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh had refused to meet him. This time the Centre's low-profile interlocutor R.S. Pandey claims to have "softened" I and M. Meanwhile, talks with ULFA have failed despite the mediation of Jnanpith Award winner Indira Goswami; so has Andhra Pradesh's dialogue with Maoists of People's War Group, ongoing since 2002. In the Indian context, talks don't seem to work. Or the Government just can't get the right formula.

by Bhavna Vij-Aurora

It is the Centre's season for talks—first with Pakistan and then with the Maoists. The farcical exchange of numbers between the Government and the Naxals withstanding, talks are nowhere on the horizon. Now the Nagas are in Delhi. The 'I' and 'M' of National

AHMEDABAD | Road Model

The success of the Bus Rapid Transport System (BRTS) model developed by the Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC) is being taken to cities like Delhi and Pune where the concept has failed or is only a partial success. The 25-km



Janmarg, as the BRTS is called in Ahmedabad, will be extended to a total 90 km, thus setting an example for other cities. The project recently won the Sustainable Transport award for visionary achievement in mass transport from the UN-backed Institute for Transportation and Development as well as an award for being the best road-based mass transport from the Union Government. For the first three months, the AMC ran the BRTS for free. Then, based on commuter feedback, it made changes in the design. Where there is a will there is a way.

by Uday Mahurkar

BUZZ OF THE WEEK

"What Bihar thinks today, India adopts tomorrow", the state Government waxed eloquent after it reserved half of all panchayat seats for women. Wish JD(U) President Sharad Yadav would adopt the same yardstick in Parliament too.

DELHI | Strike Capability

Indian Air Force (IAF) aircraft recently bombed and strafed 'terrorist training camps behind enemy lines'. Garud commandos lit up targets as Sukhois, Jaguars and Mirage 2000s dropped laser-guided munitions on the targets while drones swung high above the desert, relaying images of the battle. The firepower exercise called 'Vayushakti 2010' in Pokhran was meant to display the IAF's air-to-ground prowess. It was no coincidence that it was held less than 100 km from the Pakistan border and just three days after secretary-level talks ended. The not-so-subtle subtext to Pakistan was clear—



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another 26/11 like attack would invite aerial reprisals against terrorist training camps in POK. Defence Minister A.K. Antony spoke of 42 terrorist training camps being still active in Pakistan and senior IAF officials said that they would go across and destroy the camps if given the chance.

by Sandeep Unnithan